receiver to identify the facts relating to the subject under study, draw his own conclusions and take suitable action, based on the conclusions and recommendations. In order to achieve its purpose the report must not only be clear, concise and logical but must also be drafted according to a recognised form and arrangement.

It is however, difficult to lay down a specific set of rules for preparation of reports. Except statutory report, the nature, length and style of a report must vary with the circumstances of the case. Following are the general arrangements of content in case of formal and special reports.

a) **The Heading or Title:** A report must always have a title indicating the subject of the study, the period and the location of the study. A long report has a full title page which gives the title, the name of the person who assigned the report and the name of the person or group who prepared the report, with month and year of submission. In a short report the title appears at the top of the first page, before the text of the report.

b) **Table of Contents:** Table of contents is a list of chapters or topics contained in the report. The serial number, title and page mark of each topic is given.

c) **Body of the Report:** It is a main part of the report and is made up of the following sub-section, sub-headings or sub-titles. The body is divided into the following parts:

i) **Introduction:** It contains the terms of reference and the subject of study. Here the writer analyses the problem chosen by him in the light of the terms of reference and the relevant circumstances.

ii) **Development or Findings:** In this part the writer presents the facts and data collected with reference to his study along with the outcome of his study. The data collected may include charts, graphs and statistical tables from other published reports and presented in an organised form with heading and sub-heading for better understanding of the reader.

iii) **Conclusions or Recommendations:** In this portion the writer draws up some definite conclusions on the basis of the facts and data presented after considering all aspects of the problem in hand. He then puts forward some strong suggestions or recommendations of his own.

iv) **Appendix:** It is supplementary material given at the end of the report. This may be a copy of a questionnaire used, or plans of buildings, maps or other materials which is referred in the body of the report.

v) **References and Bibliography:** In case of long reports, the reporter had to conduct an extensive research for the preparation of the report. Under such studies, it is in practice to add a list of references and bibliography just after the appendix to indicate the sources from which the writer has drawn his materials for the report.

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